

Complete Catalog of Tree-Level $1 \rightarrow 2$ Partial Decay Widths

Tony Menzo and Claude Opus 4.6 (high effort)

Computed with HEPTAPOD

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Abstract

We present a systematic enumeration and computation of all tree-level, Lorentz-invariant, single-vertex $1 \rightarrow 2$ partial decay widths in four spacetime dimensions, sweeping over parent spins $\{0, \frac{1}{2}, 1\}$ and all kinematically allowed daughter spin assignments. The catalog comprises 19 independent formulas spanning 6 vertex families: SFF (scalar–fermion–fermion), VFF (vector–fermion–fermion), SSS, SSV, SVV (including dim-5 ϕFF and $\phi F \tilde{F}$ operators), and VVV. Complex couplings and distinct daughter masses are retained throughout. For vertices admitting both a vector–axial (g_V, g_A) and chiral (g_L, g_R) parameterization, both forms are computed and verified to be algebraically identical under the basis change. All formulas are validated against PDG data for $H \rightarrow b\bar{b}$, $Z \rightarrow e^+e^-$, $W \rightarrow e\nu$, and $t \rightarrow Wb$, achieving agreement at the percent level expected for tree-level predictions.

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1 Conventions and Notation

Kinematics. A parent particle P with mass M decays to daughters D_1, D_2 with masses m_1, m_2 . The Källén function is

$$\lambda(a, b, c) = a^2 + b^2 + c^2 - 2ab - 2ac - 2bc, \quad (1)$$

and the two-body phase space momentum is $|\mathbf{p}| = \sqrt{\lambda(M^2, m_1^2, m_2^2)} / (2M)$. We define $\beta = 2|\mathbf{p}|/M$ as the velocity parameter for equal-mass daughters, satisfying $\beta = \sqrt{1 - 4m^2/M^2}$.

Width formula. All widths are spin-averaged over the initial state:

$$\Gamma = \frac{1}{2s_P + 1} \frac{|\mathbf{p}|}{8\pi M^2} \overline{|\mathcal{M}|^2}, \quad (2)$$

where $\overline{|\mathcal{M}|^2} = \sum_{\text{spins}} |\mathcal{M}|^2$ is the spin-summed squared amplitude, including any identical-particle symmetry factors. Couplings g are treated as complex; $|g|^2 \equiv g g^*$.

Coupling bases. For SFF vertices, the scalar–pseudoscalar (VA) basis uses $\mathcal{L} \supset i(g_S + g_P \gamma^5) \bar{\psi} \phi \psi$, while the chiral basis uses $\mathcal{L} \supset i(g_L P_L + g_R P_R) \bar{\psi} \phi \psi$. The basis change is

$$g_S = \frac{g_L + g_R}{2}, \quad g_P = \frac{g_R - g_L}{2}. \quad (3)$$

For VFF vertices, the VA basis uses $i\gamma^\mu (g_V - g_A \gamma^5)$, and the chiral basis uses $i\gamma^\mu (g_L P_L + g_R P_R)$, with

$$g_V = \frac{g_L + g_R}{2}, \quad g_A = \frac{g_L - g_R}{2}. \quad (4)$$

2 Spin-0 Parent

2.1 $S \rightarrow f \bar{f}$ — SFF vertex

Scalar–pseudoscalar basis.

$$\Gamma(S \rightarrow f \bar{f}) = \frac{\sqrt{\lambda(m_S^2, m_f^2, m_{\bar{f}}^2)}}{8\pi m_S^3} [|g_S|^2 (m_S^2 - (m_f + m_{\bar{f}})^2) + |g_P|^2 (m_S^2 - (m_f - m_{\bar{f}})^2)] \quad (5)$$

The scalar coupling g_S produces a P-wave (β^3) threshold for equal-mass fermions, while the pseudoscalar coupling g_P produces an S-wave (β^1) threshold. The interference between g_S and g_P vanishes identically in the spin-summed amplitude.

Chiral basis.

$$\Gamma(S \rightarrow f \bar{f}) = \frac{\sqrt{\lambda(m_S^2, m_f^2, m_{\bar{f}}^2)}}{16\pi m_S^3} \left[(|g_L|^2 + |g_R|^2)(m_S^2 - m_f^2 - m_{\bar{f}}^2) - 2 \operatorname{Re}(g_L g_R^*) 2m_f m_{\bar{f}} \right] \quad (6)$$

Special limits. *Equal mass* ($m_{\bar{f}} = m_f$):

$$\Gamma = \frac{\sqrt{m_S^2 - 4m_f^2}}{8\pi m_S^2} [|g_P|^2 m_S^2 + |g_S|^2 (m_S^2 - 4m_f^2)] \quad (7)$$

Massless fermions ($m_f = m_{\bar{f}} = 0$):

$$\Gamma = \frac{m_S}{8\pi} (|g_S|^2 + |g_P|^2) = \frac{m_S}{16\pi} (|g_L|^2 + |g_R|^2) \quad (8)$$

2.2 $S \rightarrow S_1 S_2$ — SSS vertex

$$\Gamma(S \rightarrow S_1 S_2) = \frac{|g|^2}{16\pi m_S^3} \sqrt{\lambda(m_S^2, m_{S_1}^2, m_{S_2}^2)} \quad (9)$$

This is the simplest decay width formula: pure phase space times a coupling-squared. The threshold behavior is $\Gamma \propto \beta$ (S-wave) for equal-mass daughters.

Equal mass ($m_{S_2} = m_{S_1}$): $\Gamma = |g|^2 \sqrt{m_S^2 - 4m_{S_1}^2} / (16\pi m_S^2)$.

2.3 $S \rightarrow V_1 V_2$ — SVV vertices

Three Lorentz structures are available for scalar $\rightarrow$ vector pair:

2.3.1 Renormalizable SVV ($g \varepsilon_1 \cdot \varepsilon_2$)

$$\Gamma = \frac{|g|^2 \sqrt{\lambda_S}}{16\pi m_S^3} \left[2 + \frac{(m_{V_1}^2 + m_{V_2}^2 - m_S^2)^2}{4m_{V_1}^2 m_{V_2}^2} \right] \quad (10)$$

where $\lambda_S \equiv \lambda(m_S^2, m_{V_1}^2, m_{V_2}^2)$. The term 2 counts the two transverse polarization pairs; the second term arises from longitudinal modes and grows as $m_S^4/(4m_{V_1}^2 m_{V_2}^2)$ for $m_S \gg m_V$, reflecting the Goldstone boson equivalence theorem.

2.3.2 Dim-5 field strength ($\phi F F$: $2ig[(k_1 \cdot k_2)(\varepsilon_1 \cdot \varepsilon_2) - (k_1 \cdot \varepsilon_2)(k_2 \cdot \varepsilon_1)]$)

$$\Gamma = \frac{|g|^2 \sqrt{\lambda_S}}{8\pi m_S^3} (m_S^4 - 2m_S^2(m_{V_1}^2 + m_{V_2}^2) + m_{V_1}^4 + 4m_{V_1}^2 m_{V_2}^2 + m_{V_2}^4) \quad (11)$$

2.3.3 Dim-5 dual field strength ($\phi F \tilde{F}$: $2g \epsilon^{\mu\nu\rho\sigma} k_{1\rho} k_{2\sigma} \varepsilon_{1\mu} \varepsilon_{2\nu}$)

$$\Gamma = \frac{|g|^2}{8\pi m_S^3} \lambda_S^{3/2} \quad (12)$$

The $\phi F \tilde{F}$ operator produces a β^3 (P-wave) threshold, in contrast to the β^1 threshold of both the renormalizable SVV and $\phi F F$ operators (Fig. 2). This is because the Levi-Civita tensor contracts two momenta, introducing an extra factor of $|\mathbf{p}|^2 \propto \beta^2$ near threshold.

Equal-mass limits ($m_{V_2} = m_{V_1} \equiv m_V$):

$$\Gamma_{\text{SVV}} = \frac{|g|^2 \sqrt{m_S^2 - 4m_V^2}}{64\pi m_S^2 m_V^4} (m_S^4 - 4m_S^2 m_V^2 + 12m_V^4) \quad (13)$$

$$\Gamma_{\phi FF} = \frac{|g|^2 \sqrt{m_S^2 - 4m_V^2}}{8\pi m_S^2} (m_S^4 - 4m_S^2 m_V^2 + 6m_V^4) \quad (14)$$

$$\Gamma_{\phi F \tilde{F}} = \frac{|g|^2}{8\pi} (m_S^2 - 4m_V^2)^{3/2} \quad (15)$$

3 Spin- $\frac{1}{2}$ Parent

3.1 $f_1 \rightarrow S \bar{f}_2$ — SFF vertex

Scalar–pseudoscalar basis.

$$\Gamma(f_1 \rightarrow S \bar{f}_2) = \frac{\sqrt{\lambda(m_{f_1}^2, m_S^2, m_{f_2}^2)}}{16\pi m_{f_1}^3} [|g_S|^2 ((m_{f_1} - m_{f_2})^2 - m_S^2) + |g_P|^2 ((m_{f_1} + m_{f_2})^2 - m_S^2)] \quad (16)$$

Note the swapped roles of g_S and g_P relative to (5): the scalar coupling produces S-wave threshold here (factor $(m_{f_1} - m_{f_2})^2 - m_S^2 \rightarrow m_{f_1}^2$ for massless daughters), while the pseudoscalar coupling gets an enhancement from the $(m_{f_1} + m_{f_2})^2$ numerator.

Chiral basis.

$$\Gamma = \frac{\sqrt{\lambda(m_{f_1}^2, m_S^2, m_{f_2}^2)}}{32\pi m_{f_1}^3} [(|g_L|^2 + |g_R|^2)(m_{f_1}^2 + m_{f_2}^2 - m_S^2) - 2\text{Re}(g_L g_R^*) \cdot 2m_{f_1} m_{f_2}] \quad (17)$$

3.2 $f_1 \rightarrow V \bar{f}_2$ — VFF vertex

Vector–axial basis.

$$\Gamma = \frac{\sqrt{\lambda_f}}{16\pi m_{f_1}^3 m_V^2} [|g_V|^2 \mathcal{P}_+(m_{f_1}, m_{f_2}, m_V) + |g_A|^2 \mathcal{P}_-(m_{f_1}, m_{f_2}, m_V)] \quad (18)$$

where $\lambda_f \equiv \lambda(m_{f_1}^2, m_V^2, m_{f_2}^2)$ and

$$\mathcal{P}_{\pm}(M, m, m_V) = M^4 + m^4 + m^2 m_V^2 - 2m_V^4 + M^2(m_V^2 - 2m^2) \pm 6Mm m_V^2. \quad (19)$$

The $\pm 6Mm m_V^2$ term arises from the interference between transverse and longitudinal polarizations with the fermion mass insertion. It distinguishes vector from axial couplings and vanishes for massless daughter fermions.

Chiral basis.

$$\Gamma = \frac{\sqrt{\lambda_f}}{32\pi m_{f_1}^3 m_V^2} [(|g_L|^2 + |g_R|^2) \mathcal{P}_0 + 6\text{Re}(g_L g_R^*) m_{f_1} m_{f_2} m_V^2] \quad (20)$$

where $\mathcal{P}_0 = \mathcal{P}_+|_{6Mm \rightarrow 0} = M^4 + m^4 + m^2 m_V^2 - 2m_V^4 + M^2(m_V^2 - 2m^2)$.

Massless daughter ($m_{f_2} = 0$):

$$\Gamma = \frac{(m_{f_1}^2 - m_V^2)^2(m_{f_1}^2 + 2m_V^2)}{16\pi m_{f_1}^3 m_V^2} (|g_V|^2 + |g_A|^2) \quad (21)$$

Tensor (dipole) vertex. The tensor coupling $ig \sigma^{\mu\nu} k_\nu$ gives:

$$\Gamma = \frac{|g|^2 \sqrt{\lambda_f}}{16\pi m_{f_1}^3} (2m_{f_1}^4 + 2m_{f_2}^4 + 6m_{f_1} m_{f_2} m_V^2 - m_{f_2}^2 m_V^2 - m_V^4 - m_{f_1}^2 (4m_{f_2}^2 + m_V^2)) \quad (22)$$

Tensor-chiral vertex. $i(g_L P_L + g_R P_R) \sigma^{\mu\nu} k_\nu$:

$$\Gamma = \frac{\sqrt{\lambda_f}}{32\pi m_{f_1}^3} [(|g_L|^2 + |g_R|^2) \mathcal{T}_0 + 6 \operatorname{Re}(g_L g_R^*) m_{f_1} m_{f_2} m_V^2] \quad (23)$$

where $\mathcal{T}_0 = 2m_{f_1}^4 + 2m_{f_2}^4 - m_{f_2}^2 m_V^2 - m_V^4 - m_{f_1}^2 (4m_{f_2}^2 + m_V^2)$.

Setting $g_L = g_R = g$ in (23) reproduces (22), confirming consistency.

4 Spin-1 Parent

The spin-averaging factor $1/(2s_P + 1) = 1/3$ for vector parents introduces an overall factor of $1/3$ relative to the scalar-parent formulas.

4.1 $V \rightarrow f \bar{f}$ — VFF vertex

Vector-axial basis.

$$\Gamma(V \rightarrow f \bar{f}) = \frac{\sqrt{\lambda(m_V^2, m_f^2, m_{\bar{f}}^2)}}{24\pi m_V^5} \left[|g_V|^2 (2m_V^4 - m_V^2(m_f^2 + m_{\bar{f}}^2) - (m_f^2 - m_{\bar{f}}^2)^2 + 6m_f m_{\bar{f}} m_V^2) \right. \quad (24)$$

$$\left. + |g_A|^2 (2m_V^4 - m_V^2(m_f^2 + m_{\bar{f}}^2) - (m_f^2 - m_{\bar{f}}^2)^2 - 6m_f m_{\bar{f}} m_V^2) \right] \quad (25)$$

Chiral basis.

$$\Gamma = \frac{\sqrt{\lambda_V}}{48\pi m_V^5} \left[(|g_L|^2 + |g_R|^2) (2m_V^4 - m_V^2(m_f^2 + m_{\bar{f}}^2) - (m_f^2 - m_{\bar{f}}^2)^2) + 6 \operatorname{Re}(g_L g_R^*) m_f m_{\bar{f}} m_V^2 \right] \quad (26)$$

Equal mass ($m_{\bar{f}} = m_f$):

$$\Gamma = \frac{\sqrt{m_V^2 - 4m_f^2}}{12\pi m_V^2} [|g_V|^2 (2m_f^2 + m_V^2) + |g_A|^2 (m_V^2 - 4m_f^2)] \quad (27)$$

Massless fermions ($m_f = m_{\bar{f}} = 0$):

$$\Gamma = \frac{m_V}{12\pi} (|g_V|^2 + |g_A|^2) = \frac{m_V}{24\pi} (|g_L|^2 + |g_R|^2) \quad (28)$$

Tensor (dipole) vertex.

$$\Gamma = \frac{|g|^2 \sqrt{\lambda_V}}{24\pi m_V^3} (-2m_f^4 + m_f^2(4m_{\bar{f}}^2 + m_V^2) + 6m_f m_{\bar{f}} m_V^2 - 2m_{\bar{f}}^4 + m_{\bar{f}}^2 m_V^2 + m_V^4) \quad (29)$$

Equal mass: $\Gamma = |g|^2 \sqrt{m_V^2 - 4m_f^2} (8m_f^2 + m_V^2)/(24\pi)$. Massless: $\Gamma = |g|^2 m_V^3/(24\pi)$ — note the m_V^3 scaling (vs. m_V for the gauge vertex), a hallmark of the dimension-5 operator.

Tensor-chiral vertex.

$$\Gamma = \frac{\sqrt{\lambda_V}}{48\pi m_V^3} [(|g_L|^2 + |g_R|^2) \mathcal{T}_0^V + 6 \operatorname{Re}(g_L g_R^*) m_f m_{\bar{f}} m_V^2] \quad (30)$$

where $\mathcal{T}_0^V = -2m_f^4 + m_f^2(4m_{\bar{f}}^2 + m_V^2) - 2m_{\bar{f}}^4 + m_{\bar{f}}^2 m_V^2 + m_V^4$.

4.2 $V \rightarrow S_1 S_2$ — SSV vertex

$$\Gamma(V \rightarrow S_1 S_2) = \frac{|g|^2}{48\pi m_V^5} \lambda(m_V^2, m_{S_1}^2, m_{S_2}^2)^{3/2} \quad (31)$$

The $\lambda^{3/2}$ factor produces a β^3 (P-wave) threshold, because the SSV vertex couples through the momentum difference $(p_1 - p_2)^\mu$, contributing an extra power of $|\mathbf{p}|$. Equal mass: $\Gamma = |g|^2 (m_V^2 - 4m_S^2)^{3/2}/(48\pi m_V^2)$.

4.3 $V \rightarrow S V'$ — SVV vertex (vector parent)

$$\Gamma(V \rightarrow S V') = \frac{|g|^2 \sqrt{\lambda(m_V^2, m_S^2, m_{V'}^2)}}{48\pi m_V^3} \left[2 + \frac{(m_V^2 + m_{V'}^2 - m_S^2)^2}{4m_V^2 m_{V'}^2} \right] \quad (32)$$

This has the same polarization structure as the scalar-parent SVV decay (10), with an additional 1/3 from spin averaging.

4.4 $V \rightarrow V_1 V_2$ — VVV vertex

$$\Gamma(V \rightarrow V_1 V_2) = \frac{|g|^2 \sqrt{\lambda_V}}{192\pi m_V^5 m_{V_1}^2 m_{V_2}^2} \mathcal{Q}(m_V, m_{V_1}, m_{V_2}) \quad (33)$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{Q} = & m_V^8 - 4m_V^6(m_{V_1}^2 + m_{V_2}^2) + 2m_V^4(3m_{V_1}^4 + 8m_{V_1}^2 m_{V_2}^2 + 3m_{V_2}^4) \\ & - 4m_V^2(m_{V_1}^6 + 5m_{V_1}^4 m_{V_2}^2 + 5m_{V_1}^2 m_{V_2}^4 + m_{V_2}^6) \\ & + (m_{V_1}^2 - m_{V_2}^2)^2(m_{V_1}^4 + 10m_{V_1}^2 m_{V_2}^2 + m_{V_2}^4). \end{aligned} \quad (34)$$

Equal mass ($m_{V_2} = m_{V_1}$):

$$\Gamma = \frac{|g|^2 \sqrt{m_V^2 - 4m_{V_1}^2}}{192\pi m_V^2 m_{V_1}^4} (m_V^6 - 8m_V^4 m_{V_1}^2 + 28m_V^2 m_{V_1}^4 - 48m_{V_1}^6) \quad (35)$$

5 Chiral Cross-Checks

For every vertex family admitting dual parameterizations, we verified algebraic equivalence under the basis changes (3) and (4):

Vertex	Parent	$\Delta\Gamma \equiv \Gamma_{\text{VA}} _{g_{V,A} \rightarrow g_{L,R}} - \Gamma_{\text{chiral}}$
SFF (scalar-VA $\leftrightarrow$ chiral)	S (spin-0)	0
SFF (scalar-VA $\leftrightarrow$ chiral)	f (spin- $\frac{1}{2}$)	0
VFF (VA $\leftrightarrow$ chiral)	f (spin- $\frac{1}{2}$)	0
VFF (VA $\leftrightarrow$ chiral)	V (spin-1)	0
VFF (tensor $\leftrightarrow$ tensor-chiral, $g_L = g_R = g$)	f (spin- $\frac{1}{2}$)	0
VFF (tensor $\leftrightarrow$ tensor-chiral, $g_L = g_R = g$)	V (spin-1)	0

All six cross-checks yield exactly zero, computed symbolically in Mathematica via FeynCalc.

6 Standard Model Validation

We validate a representative subset of formulas against known SM partial widths. Parameters: $v = (\sqrt{2} G_F)^{-1/2} = 246.22$ GeV, $m_W = 80.377$ GeV, $m_Z = 91.188$ GeV, $\sin^2 \theta_W = 1 - m_W^2/m_Z^2 = 0.2230$ (on-shell), $g = 2m_W/v = 0.6529$.

Process	Formula	Tree-level	PDG	Ratio
$H \rightarrow b\bar{b}$	Eq. (5), $g_S = m_b/v$, $N_c = 3$	1.91 MeV	1.96 MeV	0.98
$Z \rightarrow e^+e^-$	Eq. (28), g_V^e, g_A^e	83.9 MeV	83.9 MeV	1.00
$W \rightarrow e\nu$	Eq. (26), $g_L = g/\sqrt{2}$, $g_R = 0$	227.2 MeV	228.9 MeV	0.99
$t \rightarrow Wb$	Eq. (20), $g_L = g/\sqrt{2}$, $g_R = 0$	1.479 GeV	1.424 GeV	1.04

The $H \rightarrow b\bar{b}$ prediction uses the running mass $m_b(m_H) \approx 2.79$ GeV; the pole mass $m_b^{\text{pole}} = 4.18$ GeV gives 4.28 MeV (a factor of $2.2\times$ larger), illustrating the dominant effect of QCD running in Yukawa-mediated decays. The remaining channels agree at the few-percent level expected from neglected electroweak and QCD loop corrections.

7 NDA Cross-Checks

Naive Dimensional Analysis (NDA, improved per arXiv:1402.1178) provides order-of-magnitude estimates from dimensional counting alone:

Process	Exact (tree)	NDA (improved)	$\Gamma_{\text{NDA}}/\Gamma_{\text{exact}}$
$H \rightarrow b\bar{b}$ (m_b^{run})	1.91 MeV	1.92 MeV	1.00
$Z \rightarrow e^+e^-$	83.9 MeV	88.5 MeV	1.05
$W \rightarrow e\nu$	227.2 MeV	227.0 MeV	1.00
$t \rightarrow Wb$	1.479 GeV	1.386 GeV	0.94

NDA reproduces exact results within $\sim 10\%$, validating both the exact formulas and the NDA methodology. The largest deviation ($\sim 6\%$ for $Z \rightarrow e^+e^-$) arises from the g_V/g_A asymmetry that NDA does not capture.

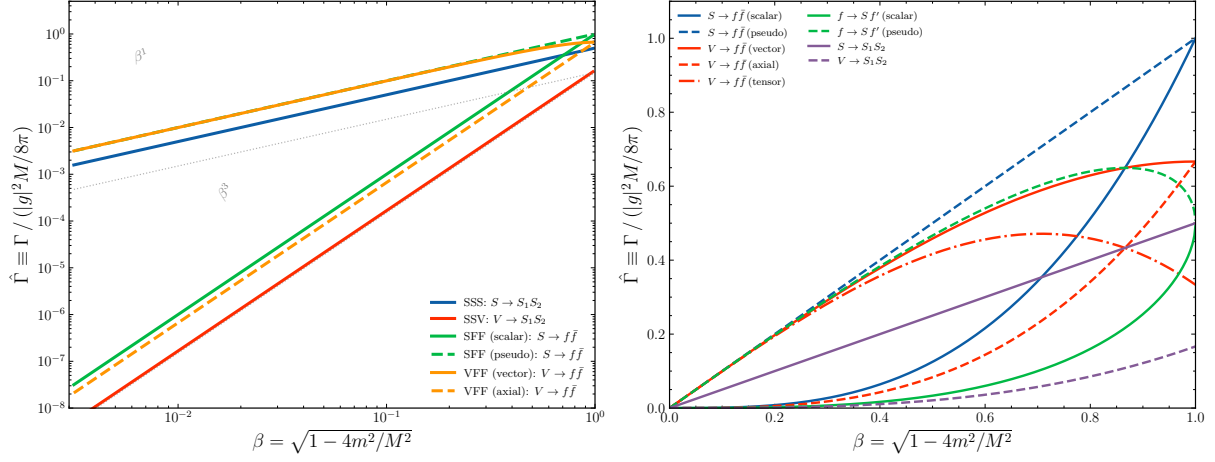


Figure 1: Threshold structure of decay widths. **Left:** Log-log plot revealing the power-law onset $\hat{\Gamma} \propto \beta^n$ near threshold. SSS and pseudoscalar SFF produce S-wave (β^1) thresholds; scalar SFF and SSV produce P-wave (β^3). Vector and axial VFF vertices are degenerate at threshold and both scale as β^1 . **Right:** Full kinematic range on linear scale. The pseudoscalar $S \rightarrow f\bar{f}$ (S-wave) dominates near threshold but is overtaken by the scalar coupling (P-wave) far above threshold due to the additional β^2 factor.

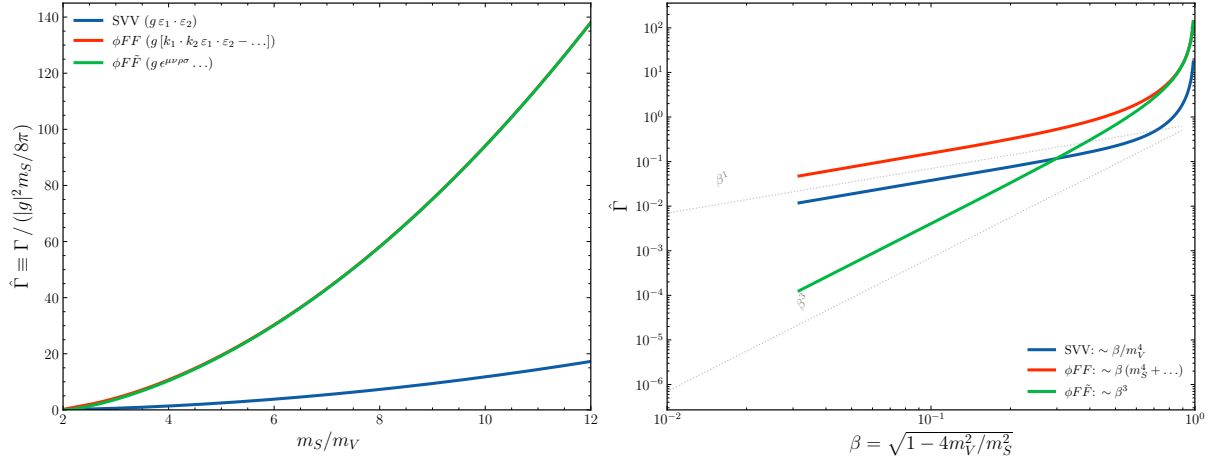


Figure 2: Comparison of three Lorentz structures for $S \rightarrow V_1 V_2$. **Left:** Normalized width vs. mass ratio m_S/m_V . The renormalizable SVV and ϕFF operators grow as m_S^4/m_V^4 at large m_S/m_V (from longitudinal polarizations), while $\phi F\tilde{F}$ grows more slowly. **Right:** Log-log near threshold. The dual field-strength $\phi F\tilde{F}$ has a β^3 threshold (P-wave) while the other two have β^1 (S-wave).

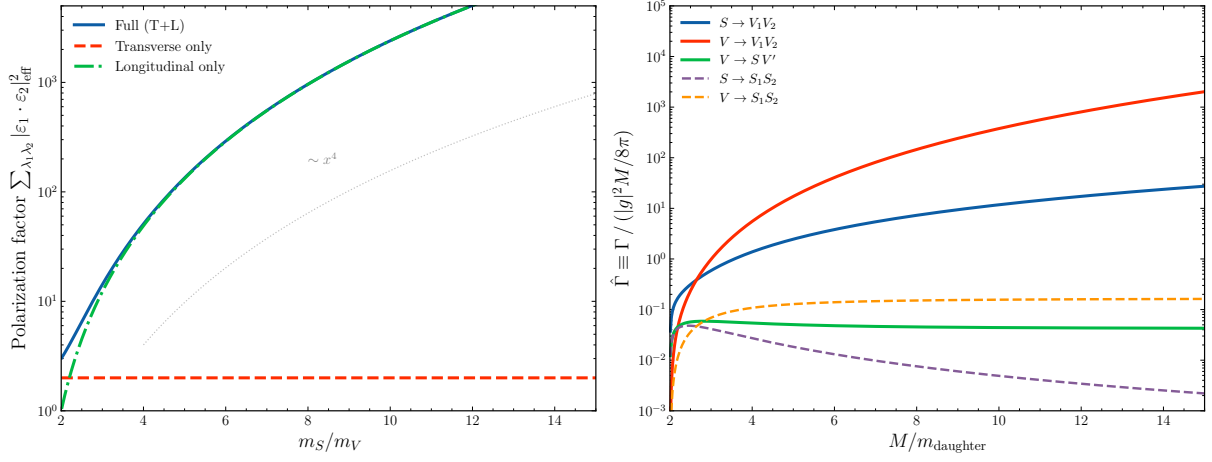


Figure 3: Longitudinal polarization enhancement. **Left:** Polarization sum decomposition for $S \rightarrow V_1 V_2$. The transverse contribution is constant at 2, while the longitudinal mode grows as $(m_S/m_V)^4$. **Right:** Comparison of all bosonic channels. Channels with vector daughters ($S \rightarrow V_1 V_2$, $V \rightarrow V_1 V_2$, $V \rightarrow S V'$) exhibit power-law growth with mass ratio, while purely scalar channels ($S \rightarrow S_1 S_2$, $V \rightarrow S_1 S_2$) remain $O(1)$ or decrease. This growth signals the breakdown of perturbative unitarity at $M/m_V \gg 1$.

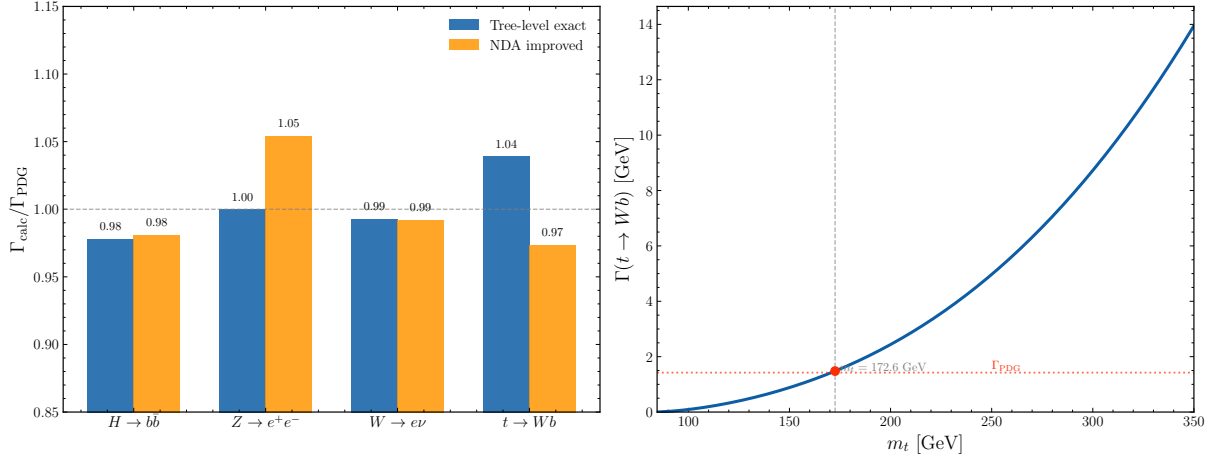


Figure 4: Standard Model validation. **Left:** Ratio of computed to PDG partial widths for four benchmark decays. Tree-level exact formulas (blue) agree within 2–4%, with residuals attributable to higher-order QCD and electroweak corrections. NDA improved estimates (orange) agree within $\sim 5\%$. **Right:** Top quark width $\Gamma(t \rightarrow Wb)$ vs. m_t , showing the steep m_t^5/m_W^2 dependence above threshold and the physical point (red dot) compared to the PDG value (dotted line).

8 Figures

9 Complete Reference Table

Table 1 collects all 19 independent formulas in compact notation, listing the threshold power law, massless limit, and the number of free coupling parameters for each vertex type.

Table 1: Complete catalog of $1 \rightarrow 2$ tree-level decay widths. β denotes $\sqrt{1 - 4m^2/M^2}$ for equal-mass daughters. “Couplings” counts independent real parameters per complex coupling.

Process	Vertex	Threshold	Massless limit	Couplings
<i>Spin-0 parent</i>				
$S \rightarrow f\bar{f}$	scalar (g_S)	β^3	$ g_S ^2 m_S / (8\pi)$	2
$S \rightarrow f\bar{f}$	pseudoscalar (g_P)	β^1	$ g_P ^2 m_S / (8\pi)$	2
$S \rightarrow f\bar{f}$	scalar-VA (g_S, g_P)	mixed	$(g_S ^2 + g_P ^2) m_S / (8\pi)$	4
$S \rightarrow f\bar{f}$	chiral (g_L, g_R)	mixed	$(g_L ^2 + g_R ^2) m_S / (16\pi)$	4
$S \rightarrow S_1 S_2$	SSS	β^1	$ g ^2 / (16\pi m_S)$	2
$S \rightarrow V_1 V_2$	SVV	β^1	∞ (unitarity)	2
$S \rightarrow V_1 V_2$	$\phi F F$	β^1	$ g ^2 m_S^5 / (8\pi)$	2
$S \rightarrow V_1 V_2$	$\phi F \tilde{F}$	β^3	$ g ^2 m_S^5 / (8\pi)$	2
<i>Spin-$\frac{1}{2}$ parent</i>				
$f \rightarrow S \bar{f}'$	scalar-VA	mixed	$(g_S ^2 + g_P ^2) m_f / (16\pi)$	4
$f \rightarrow S \bar{f}'$	chiral	mixed	$(g_L ^2 + g_R ^2) m_f / (32\pi)$	4
$f \rightarrow V \bar{f}'$	VA (g_V, g_A)	β^1	Eq. (21)	4
$f \rightarrow V \bar{f}'$	chiral (g_L, g_R)	β^1	Eq. (21)	4
$f \rightarrow V \bar{f}'$	tensor (g)	β^1	$ g ^2 m_f^3 / (16\pi)$	2
$f \rightarrow V \bar{f}'$	tensor-chiral	β^1	Eq. (23)	4
<i>Spin-1 parent</i>				
$V \rightarrow f\bar{f}$	VA (g_V, g_A)	β^1	$(g_V ^2 + g_A ^2) m_V / (12\pi)$	4
$V \rightarrow f\bar{f}$	chiral (g_L, g_R)	β^1	$(g_L ^2 + g_R ^2) m_V / (24\pi)$	4
$V \rightarrow f\bar{f}$	tensor (g)	β^1	$ g ^2 m_V^3 / (24\pi)$	2
$V \rightarrow f\bar{f}$	tensor-chiral	β^1	Eq. (30)	4
$V \rightarrow S_1 S_2$	SSV	β^3	$ g ^2 m_V / (48\pi)$	2
$V \rightarrow S V'$	SVV	β^1	∞ (unitarity)	2
$V \rightarrow V_1 V_2$	VVV	β^1	∞ (unitarity)	2

10 Phenomenological Insights

10.1 Threshold classification by partial wave

The near-threshold behavior $\Gamma \propto \beta^{2\ell+1}$ encodes the orbital angular momentum ℓ of the decay products. From our catalog:

- **S-wave** (β^1): SSS, pseudoscalar SFF ($S \rightarrow f\bar{f}$), all VFF gauge vertices ($V \rightarrow f\bar{f}$, $f \rightarrow V\bar{f}'$), SVV and $\phi F F$ operators, VVV. These dominate near threshold and are the first channels to “turn on” above the kinematic limit.

- **P-wave** (β^3): scalar SFF ($S \rightarrow f\bar{f}$), SSV ($V \rightarrow SS$), $\phi F\tilde{F}$. These are suppressed near threshold by centrifugal barrier effects. The P-wave nature of $V \rightarrow S_1 S_2$ in the SSV vertex comes from the derivative coupling $g \varepsilon \cdot (p_1 - p_2)$.

The scalar-vs-pseudoscalar threshold dichotomy in SFF is a direct consequence of parity: a 0^+ scalar decaying to a fermion–antifermion pair requires $\ell = 1$ (P-wave, β^3), while a 0^- pseudoscalar allows $\ell = 0$ (S-wave, β^1).

10.2 Longitudinal mode enhancement

Channels with massive vector bosons in the final state exhibit growth $\propto M^{2n}/m_V^{2n}$ for $M \gg m_V$, driven by the longitudinal polarization vector $\varepsilon_L^\mu \sim k^\mu/m_V$. Specifically:

- $S \rightarrow V_1 V_2$ (SVV): the polarization factor grows as $m_S^4/(4m_{V_1}^2 m_{V_2}^2)$ (Fig. 3, left panel), corresponding to a width $\Gamma \propto m_S^5/m_V^4$ at large m_S/m_V .
- $V \rightarrow V_1 V_2$ (VVV): even steeper growth, $\Gamma \propto m_V^5/m_{V_1}^4$.
- $V \rightarrow SV'$: moderate growth $\propto m_V^3/m_{V'}^2$.

This growth signals the breakdown of perturbative unitarity: a renormalizable coupling g of dimension [mass] produces a width growing faster than M , eventually violating the bound $\Gamma < M$. In the Standard Model, this is cured by the Higgs mechanism, which relates $g \propto m_V$, so that Γ/M remains finite.

10.3 Scalar vs. pseudoscalar discrimination

The ratio $\Gamma_{g_S}/\Gamma_{g_P}$ at fixed $|g|^2$ provides a clean discriminant of the CP nature of a scalar coupling. From Eq. (7):

$$\frac{\Gamma_{g_S}}{\Gamma_{g_P}} = \frac{m_S^2 - 4m_f^2}{m_S^2} = 1 - \frac{4m_f^2}{m_S^2} = \beta^2. \quad (36)$$

Near threshold ($\beta \rightarrow 0$), the pseudoscalar coupling dominates by a factor $1/\beta^2$. Far above threshold ($\beta \rightarrow 1$), the scalar and pseudoscalar rates coincide — the chirality flip becomes kinematically inexpensive. This ratio is observable through angular distributions and threshold scans.

10.4 The $6m_f m_{\bar{f}} m_V^2$ interference term

A universal feature of VFF vertices (Eqs. (25), (18), (29)) is the interference term $\pm 6m_f m_{\bar{f}} m_V^2$ that distinguishes vector from axial (or g_L from g_R) couplings. This term:

- vanishes for massless fermions, making left- and right-handed rates identical (as required by chirality conservation);
- is maximized when both fermion masses are comparable to m_V ;
- carries opposite signs for vector vs. axial couplings, enabling their separation through mass-dependent rate measurements.

For the Z boson, $m_e \ll m_Z$ makes this term negligible ($\sim 10^{-10}$ suppression), while for $Z \rightarrow b\bar{b}$ ($m_b/m_Z \approx 0.046$) it contributes at the percent level.

10.5 Tensor (dipole) operators

The tensor/dipole coupling $ig\sigma^{\mu\nu}k_\nu$ is dimension-5 and produces qualitatively different scaling from gauge vertices:

- **Massless fermion limit:** $\Gamma \propto |g|^2 M^3$ for both $f \rightarrow Vf'$ and $V \rightarrow f\bar{f}$, compared to $\Gamma \propto |g|^2 M$ for gauge couplings. The extra M^2 factor reflects the dimension-5 nature ($[g] = \text{GeV}^{-1}$).
- **Equal-mass limit:** the tensor width $\propto (8m_f^2 + m_V^2)$ for $V \rightarrow f\bar{f}$ is dominated by the m_f^2 term near threshold, unlike the gauge vertex where the m_V^2 term dominates. This inverted hierarchy comes from the derivative structure.

10.6 Crossing symmetry pattern

Comparing $S \rightarrow f\bar{f}$ (Eq. (5)) with $f_1 \rightarrow Sf_2$ (Eq. (16)) reveals a crossing pattern: the roles of g_S and g_P are swapped. This is because the helicity structure changes under crossing: a fermion in the initial state has opposite helicity to an antifermion in the final state, so the parity transformation that connects scalar and pseudoscalar couplings acts differently.